

---BREAKDOWNS---

The Big Sciota

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, 3, G, C, D, D, G, G, D, D, Em, Em, C, D, D, G.

The main melody is written in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 4/4 time signature. It begins with a repeat sign and a first ending marked with a '3'. The accompaniment is written in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 4/4 time signature. It begins with a repeat sign and ends with a final cadence.

Variation 1

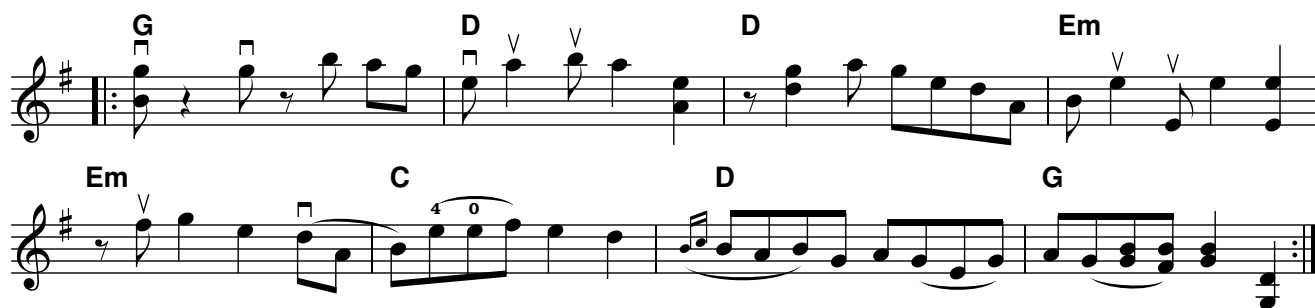
Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, 3, G, C, D, D, G, G, D, D, Em, Em, C, D, D, G.

Variation 1 features a more complex melody with many slurs and ties. The accompaniment also includes slurs and ties, with some notes marked with a 'v' (accents). The key signature remains one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4.

Variation 2

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, 4, G, G, C, D, G, 4.

Variation 2 features a simpler melody with many slurs and ties. The accompaniment also includes slurs and ties, with some notes marked with a 'v' (accents). The key signature remains one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4.



Notes: Named after the Scioto River in Ohio. Also spelled Scioti, Scioty, etc.

Neat tune! Simple in its basic form, but it has really grown on me. I'm afraid I don't know if there's a "standard" form of the tune; this is just me cobbling together what I've heard and what I've invented on top of it.

Bitter Creek

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G C G D

G C D G

G C G D

G C D G

{B}

G C G D

G C D G

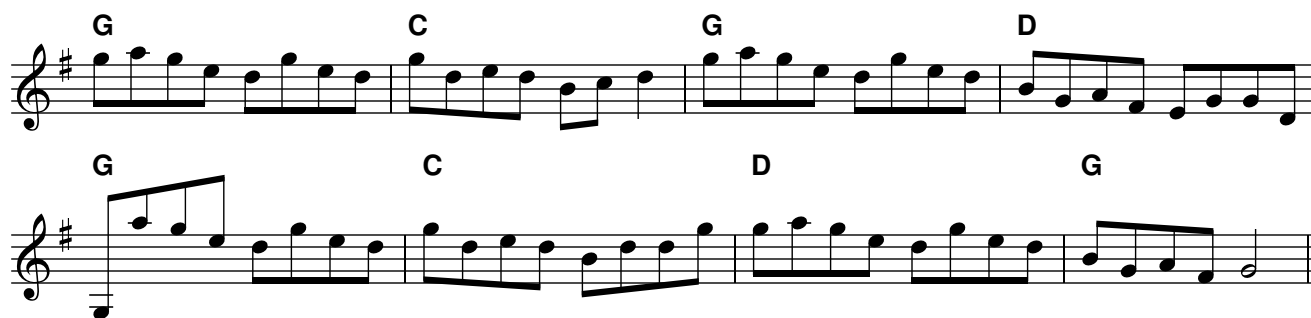
G C G D

G C D G

{A} (var.)

G C G D

G C D G



Source: A-part var. by Oscar Harper at https://tunearch.org/wiki/Bitter_Creek.

Blackberry Blossom

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 1

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 2

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 3

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G ³ D G
 G F#m C G C G A D
 G F#m C G C G D G
 Em Em/G B7 B7/F#
 Em A D G
 Em Em/G B7 B7/F#
 Em A D G

Notes: Thanks to Chris Daring for the transcription!

Done Gone

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 110$

A-part **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** | 1 **F** | 2 **F** **B $\flat$** |

B-part **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **F**

B $\flat$ **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **F** **F** **B $\flat$**

C-part **Gm** **D7**

Gm **D7** **Gm**

---HORNPIPES AND REELS---

The Bamburgh Rants

The Collpitts, The General Gordon, and Ye Old Elm Tree

Martin Matthews
rant

♩ = 105
Collpitts Rant

The image displays a musical score for guitar, written in G major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The score consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The chords D, G, D, E, A, and D are indicated above the staff. The second staff continues the melody with chords G, D, A, D, G, and D. The third staff features a first ending marked '1' with a repeat sign, followed by a second ending marked '2'. The fourth staff includes chords G, D, E, and A. The fifth and sixth staves continue the melodic development with chords G, D, E, A, and D. The score is written in a clear, legible font, with notes and rests clearly defined. The overall layout is clean and professional, typical of a printed musical score.

General Gordon Rant

The image displays a musical score for the song "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. It consists of four staves of music, each with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a common time signature (C). The melody is written on a single staff, while the guitar accompaniment is indicated by chords placed above the staff. The chords are: G, C, Am, D, G, C, G, C, G, D, G, C, C/C#, D, G, G/G#, A, D, Em, C, D, and G. The melody is written in a single staff, and the guitar accompaniment is indicated by chords placed above the staff. The score includes a repeat sign at the beginning and end of the piece.

Ye Old Elm Tree Rant

The musical score for 'Ye Old Elm Tree Rant' is written in A major (three sharps) and 4/4 time. It consists of four staves of music. The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a key signature change to A major. The chords are A, D, A, D, B7, and E. The second staff continues the melody with chords A, D, A, D, E, and A. The third staff starts with a repeat sign and a key signature change to A major, with chords E, F#m, D, and E. The fourth staff continues with chords A, D, E, A, D, A, E, and A. The score includes various musical notations such as eighth notes, quarter notes, and ornaments (marked with 'V').

Source: _Colpitts to Elm Tree_. See recording at <https://youtu.be/LkPSt-0y4q0?si=icA6Cvp1B5L5daSQ>.

Notes: These are named after the 3 pubs which have hosted the Monday session in Durham over the last 50 years.

Blackbird Hornpipe (1)

Trad.
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D G C

D C D

D G C

D C D

{B}

D G D A7

D G C D

D G D A7

D G C D

{B} (low)

D G D A7

D G C D

Source: Amanda Kerr; Randal Bays + Dave Marshall (with my own licks added)

Blackbird Hornpipe (2)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D C D A7 D

{B}

D G D

D G D

{C}

D C D

D C D

Source: Padraig McGovern and Peter Carberry: <https://youtu.be/5vidJn-Ebyc?si=eCc98qBibmGQ52gS>

Notes: This is another version of the Blackbird Hornpipe, clearly related to the previous one.

A little more repetitive, but in a good way! Good as a reference.

Chording remains basic / uncertain.

Boil The Breakfast Early

reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

The musical score for "Boil The Breakfast Early" is written in 4/4 time with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The score consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. It includes a repeat sign followed by a double bar line. The music is written in a single melodic line. The second staff continues the melody. The third staff begins with a repeat sign and a double bar line. The fourth staff continues the melody. The fifth staff begins with a repeat sign and a double bar line. The sixth staff continues the melody and ends with a double bar line.

Brenda Stubbert's Reel

a.k.a. Frosty Morning

*Jerry Holland
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Am G

Am Em G Em Am

{B}

Am G

1 F C Em Am

2 Am G Em Am

Source: Ashley MacIsaac (Hi(tm) How Are You Today?, 1995)

Notes: Ashley plays it in Bb, but the standard key is A Dorian. I like his accidentals.

Butterfly Hornpipe

(a.k.a. Dew Drop)

Trad.
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

A B7 E A D E A

{B}

E A B7 E A B7 E A B7 E A

Variation 1

A B7 E

The musical score is written for guitar in A major (three sharps: F#, C#, G#). It consists of seven staves of music. The chords and techniques indicated are as follows:

- Staff 1:** Chords A, D, E, A. Techniques: triplet (3), vibrato (v), and a bend (marked with a square and a diagonal line).
- Staff 2:** Chords A, B7, E. Techniques: vibrato (v) and a bend.
- Staff 3:** Chords A, D, E, A. Techniques: vibrato (v), triplet (3), and a bend.
- Staff 4:** Chords E, A₁, B7, E. Techniques: triplet (3), vibrato (v), and a bend.
- Staff 5:** Chords A, B7, E, A. Techniques: triplet (3), vibrato (v), and a bend.
- Staff 6:** Chords E, A, B7, E. Techniques: triplet (3), vibrato (v), and a bend.
- Staff 7:** Chords A, B7, E, A. Techniques: triplet (3), vibrato (v), and a bend.

Source: Terry Morris, _For the Record_; variation 1 by Chris Daring.

The Come Hither Stare

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}



{B}



Source: Eliot Grasso & Dave Cory (2020) - North by NorthWest

Cuckoo's Nest

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D A7 C G

D G D A7 D

D A7 C G

D G D A7 D

{B}

D C

D G D A7 D

D C

D G D A7 D

Notes: Interestingly, _The Fiddler's Bible_ reverses the order of parts.

The Democratic Hornpipe

a.k.a. Galway Bay

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Em G

Em D B7 Em

{B}

Em G D

G D G D B7 Em

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ (transposed to Em)

Notes: A really interesting tune with a lot of movement. Also frequently played in Gm, but I don't want the guitarists to murder me. Chording is still tentative.

The Derry Reel

Eugene O'Donnell?
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Part A:

- Staff 1: A, E, A, D
- Staff 2: A, E, A, E, A
- Staff 3: A, E, A, D, 3
- Staff 4: A, E, A, E, A, 3

Part B:

- Staff 1: F#m, E, F#m, E, F#m
- Staff 2: A, E, A, E, A
- Staff 3: F#m, E, F#m, E, F#m, 3
- Staff 4: A, E, A, E, A, 3

Notes: Cobbled from two versions found at thesession.org/tunes/7671. I really like the B-part!

The Durham Hornpipe

James Hill
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

E E F#m B7 A E A B7

E F#m B7 A E B7 | 1 E | 2 E

{B}

B7 E G#m C#7

E A B7 A E B7 | 1 E | 2 E

Source: _The Lads Like Beer_

Notes: A hornpipe in E! Nice! Like many Hill tunes, it has some twisty bits.

Fisher's Hornpipe (D)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

The musical score for Fisher's Hornpipe (D) is presented in two systems, each containing four staves of music in 4/4 time, key of D major. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 105. The first system is labeled {A} and the second system is labeled {B}. The music features various chords (D, G, A) and triplets. The first system ends with a repeat sign, and the second system ends with a double bar line.

Notes: This is commonly played in either D or F major. Here are some examples of it in D, sourced and adapted from various transcriptions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Fisher's Hornpipe (F)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F C

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ C F

{B}

C F C C

B $\flat$ F C F

{A} (var.)

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F C

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ C F

{C}

F B $\flat$ F C

B $\flat$ F C F

3

Notes: Here's the F version as I learned it, along with a nice variation on the A-part
I found at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Frosty Rushes

Martin Matthews
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 95$

{A}

3 F 3 B $\flat$ C F C7

1 3 1 3 0 2

F B $\flat$ C F C7 1 F 2 F

{B}

Dm A7

1 Dm A7

2 F Gm C7

3

Source: _Colpitts to Elm Tree_, slightly modified

Gin Rickshaw

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D Em D G D A7

D Em D A7 D

D Em D G D A7

D Em D A7 D

{B}

D G D A7

D G A7 D

D G D A7

D G A7 D

Hummingbird Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

A E A E

A E A E A

A E A E

A E A E A

3

{B}

A E

A E A

A E

A E A

The Humours of Tulla

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D D Em D G A7

D D Em D G A7

{B}

D D G D G A7

D D G D G A7

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/141>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! First comes the basic melody, then my variations.
The G and Em chords are fairly interchangeable. I mix and match them in this arrangement.

The Kitchen Girl

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 110$
{A}

Musical notation for section A, consisting of two staves in 4/4 time. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a double bar line. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, G, A, A, E7. The second staff continues the melody with chords: A, G, A, G, E7, A. The section ends with a repeat sign and a double bar line.

{B}

Musical notation for section B, consisting of two staves in 4/4 time. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a double bar line. Chords are indicated above the notes: Am, G, Am, Am, E7. The second staff continues the melody with chords: Am, G, Am, Am, G, Am. The section ends with a repeat sign and a double bar line.

Variation

Musical notation for the Variation section, consisting of four staves in 4/4 time. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a double bar line. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, G, A, A, E7. The second staff continues the melody with chords: A, G, A, G, E7, A. The third staff continues the melody with chords: Am, G, Am, Am, E7. The fourth staff continues the melody with chords: Am, G, Am, Am, G, Am. The section ends with a repeat sign and a double bar line.

Source: _Kentucky Open Band Contra Tunes_, with some original variations.

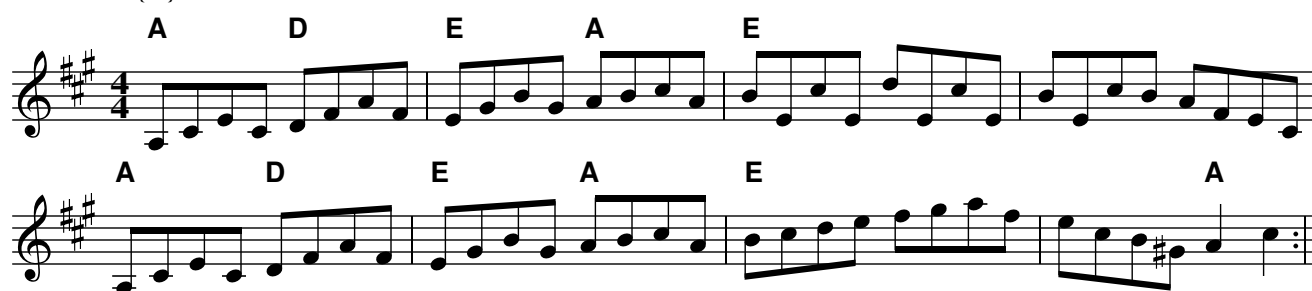
Notes: Great jam tune. For inspiration, see https://youtu.be/912wUcMXG_0?feature=shared

Miller's Reel

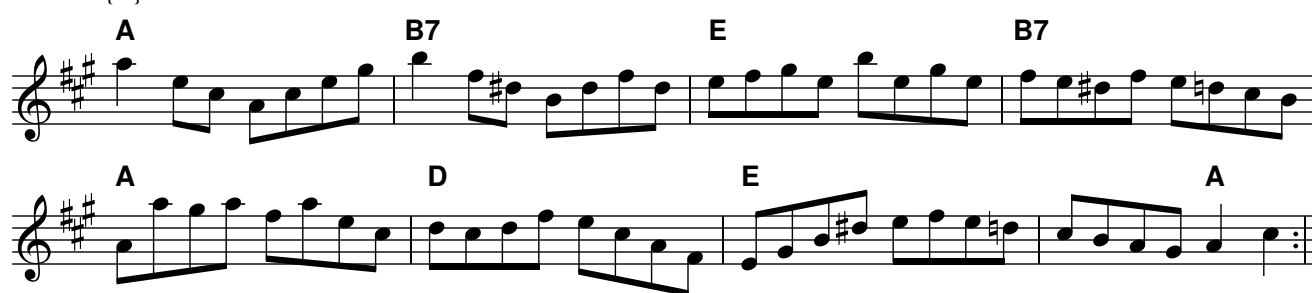
*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}



{B}

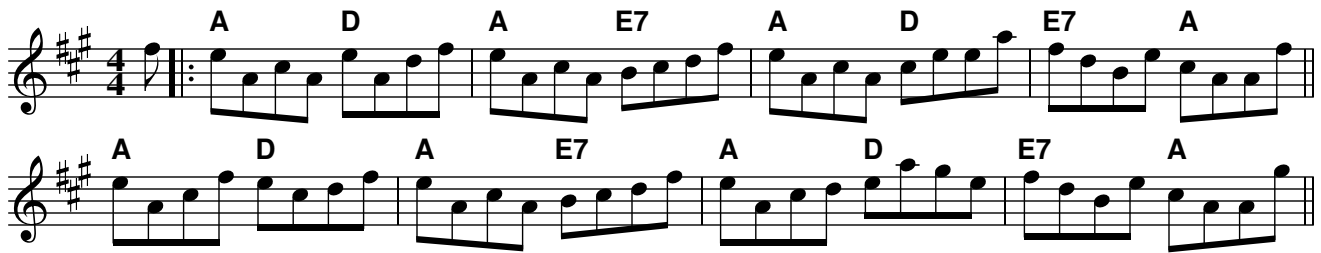


Money Musk

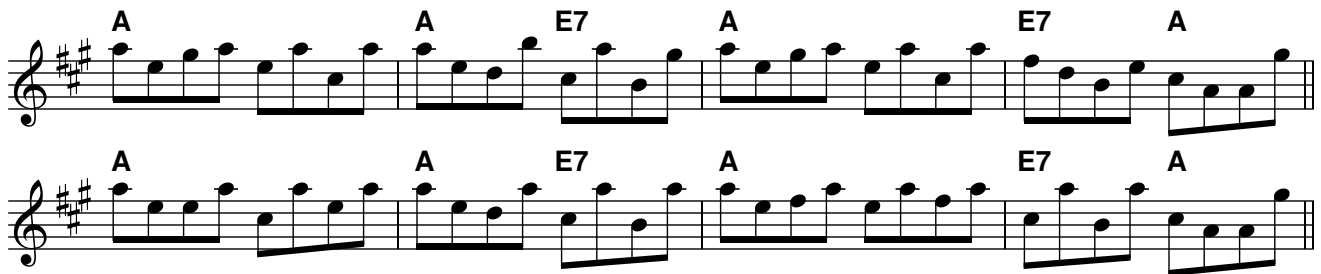
*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

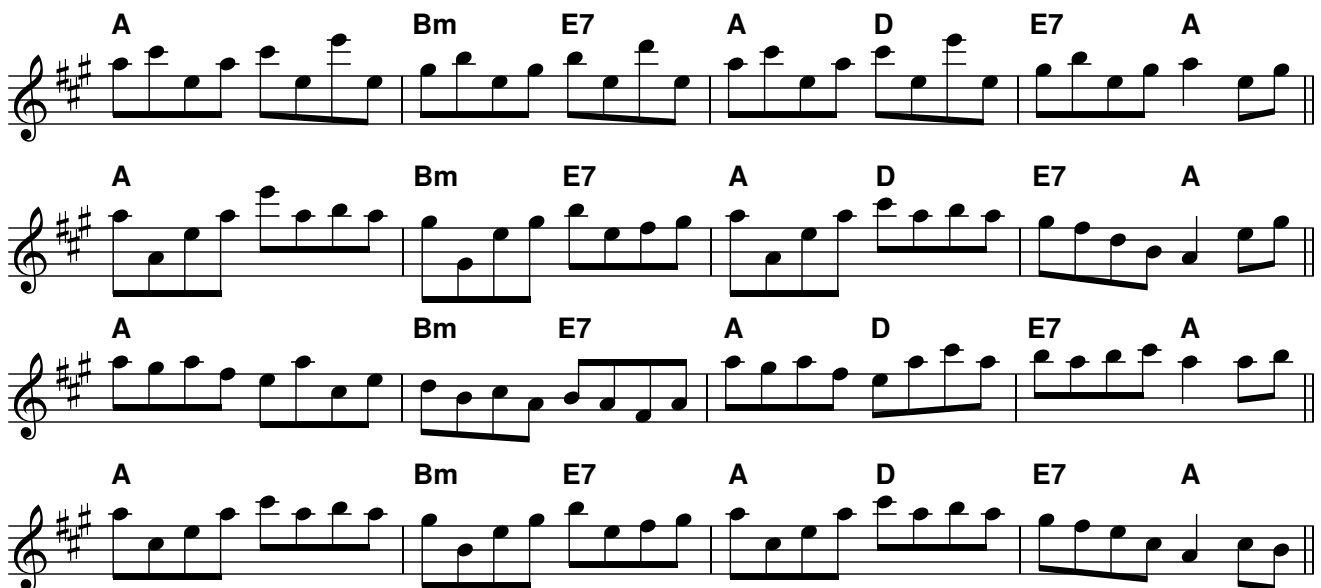
{A} (2 variations)



{B} (2 variations)



{C} (4 variations)



D-part



Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ for the base, plus variations by Tom Wiesgerber.

Notes: Great tune with oodles of variations! Choose your favorite version(s) of A, B, and C, then play: Ax2 > Bx2 > Cx2 or D (some play both) > repeat from the top.

The Morpeth Rant

William Sheild
rant

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

{B}

Source: Stewart Hardy, <https://youtu.be/ogZMXmpvqh4?si=OReaCGFonFyUaiGt>.

Notes: The unofficial "national" tune of Northumberland. It is popular to play this in a set with The Old Morpeth Rant and Roxburgh Castle.

The Old Morpeth Rant

*Trad.
rant*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A} G C G Am D7

1 G C G D7 G 3

2 G C G D7 G

{B}

G D7 C Am D7

1 C D7 G D7 G

2 C D7 G D7 G

Source: Stewart Hardy, https://youtu.be/d0AWDc_zuK0?si=Nra7JSgGlfhzKS1A.

Notes: More regional interest: the rant is a local form, connected with the Rapper Sword dance;
"musically it is similar to a reel, though somewhat slower, and with more of a lilt."
(https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Music_of_Northumbria). Some also play it in Bb.

The Mortgage Burn

Gordon MacLean
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

A A Bm Bm E7

A A Bm E7 A

A C#m D A Bm F#m E A

1 A C#m D A Bm F#m E A

2 A F#m C#m D A F#m E A

Source: _Ho-Ro-Gheallaidh vol. 3_; <https://thesession.org/tunes/2047>

Notes: Wild chord changes in the {B} part! Love it!

New Reel

*Dale Morris
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

{B}

Notes: A somewhat mysterious tune I found amongst the practice / lesson tapes from Dale Morris that my teacher passed on to me. I only have it down as "New Reel" (was it Dale's composition?), but it might be a traditional tune.

da New Rigged Ship + Shelder Geo

pronounced "gyo"

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

da New Rigged Ship

Chords for 'da New Rigged Ship':

- Staff 1: A, G, D
- Staff 2: A, G, D
- Staff 3: A, E7, A, E7, A, E7, 1 A, 2 A
- Staff 4: Am, G, Am, Em, Am, G, Am

Shelder Geo

Chords for 'Shelder Geo':

- Staff 1: D, C, G, D, G, D
- Staff 2: C, C, C, D
- Staff 3: C, C, C, D

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990).

Notes: This set segues nicely to Sleep Soond i da Moarnin.

Nichol Caisley's

Damian Caisley (2007)
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D G A D Bm Em G A

D G A D G D 1 A7 D 2 A7 D

{B}

A D G D

A D G 1 A7 D 2 A7 D

3

The Nine Points of Roguery

a.k.a. The Black Mare of Fanad

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 100$
{A} D G D Bm C G

D G D A7 D

{B} C G D Bm C G

C G D A7 D

{A'} D G D Bm C G

D G D A7 D

{B} C D Bm C G

C G D A7 D

Variation D G D Bm C G

D G D Bm C G

Source: Loosely from Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990) and _Ho-ro-gheallaidh vol. 1_.

Notes: It's common to play an Em in the 4th bar of this tune (both A and B parts), but I've also seen it done with C and I really like how that sounds. Those who want to play the melody over an Em chord can substitute a B note for the C at that measure.

Old Joe Clark

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105

{A}

A A A E

A A A G A

{B}

A A A G

A A A G A

Notes: This is a popular bluegrass tune. Here is a simple version I got from a mandolin lesson. Will work with this more in the future.

Old Straw Bonnet

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G F G D

G F G C D 1 2 3

{B}

G F 3

G C D G 3

{C} Gm D7

Gm D7 1 Gm 2

Notes: Great tune; this is the basic way I play it.

Opera Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}.1

D A D G A

D D A D G A

{A}.2

D D A D G A 3

D D A D G A

{B}.1

D A D G D G A D

D A D G D G A D

{B}.2

D A D G D G A D

D A D G D G A D³

Source: KY Contra Tunes and some online variants

Notes: This is interesting! Basically the usual A and B parts, but each part seems to have distinct variations on each. It's got a great build.

Peerless Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\mathcal{J} = 105$

 $\{A\}$

The guitar solo in 'Billie Jean' is a 4/4 piece consisting of two lines of music. The first line begins with a repeat sign and contains a triplet of eighth notes at the end. The second line concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots. Chords C, G7, F, and C are indicated above the notes.

 $\{\mathbf{B}\}$

Source: The Fiddler's Bible.

Petronella

reel

$\text{♩} = 105$



Devil



Maxwell



Linton



St Annes



♩ = 105

{A} D A D G

D A D A

D G 1 A D 2 A D

{B} A D G E

E A A D

G A 1 D 2 D

Rackety Jack's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G C G D

G C D D G

{B}

G C G D

G C D D G

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

The Rights of Man

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Em G D C Bm

Em G D Em

{B}

G Em G Em D Bm

C Am Em Am D Em

Notes: Popularly paired with The Democratic Hornpipe.
Also features in the set: King of Fairies > Off to California > Rights of Man.

Roxburgh Castle

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G C G C Am D7

G C G G D7 G

{B}

G C G Am D7

G C G D7 G

Source: <https://thesession.org/tunes/4628>

Rye Straw (D)

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

A D A D A D E A

A D A D A D E A

{B}

A D A G D

A D A D E A

{C}

D G D A D

G A D A A D D.C.

Source: Todd Phillips + Darol Anger, *In the Pines* (1995) [with many modifications]

Notes: Rye Straw seems to have a zillion variations. The core of this version draws from Darol Anger's arrangement, where he seems to mash the 16 bars of one of its usual B-parts to create a 'bridge' C-part of 10 bars. It's pretty neat!

Rye Straw (D) v.2

Trad. + Dave Notman
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

{B}

Notes: A version of Rye Straw heavily modified by Dave Notman.

Rye Straw (G)

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

{B}

Source: Doc Roberts, followed by a few variations I've heard.

Notes: Note about the chords - this can easily follow a straight G pattern, but I kind of like the "rocking" pattern between G and C on the A part that I've heard in other versions.

Saint Anne's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D A D G D

D A D G A D

D A D G D

D A D G A D

{B}

D G A D

D G A D

D G A D

D G A D

Source: A combination of two versions at thesession.org/tunes/103

Notes: A rather jaunty tune, with a nice melody. Something to explore?

Sally Growler

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G C G A D

G C G C G D G

{B}

G G D7 D7 G G D7 G

3

Salt Creek

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A} A A D G

G E A A D

1 A E A 2 A E A

{B} A A G G

A A A E A

Source: An online intro to mandolin tutorial

Notes: VERY similar to Salt River, but the B-part is different

Salt River

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A}

Musical notation for section {A} (measures 1-8). The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on four staves. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, A, G, G, A, D, E, E, A.

{B}

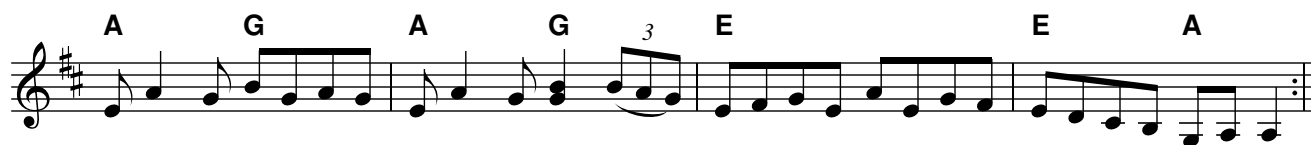
Musical notation for section {B} (measures 9-16). The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on two staves. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, G, A, G, A, G, E, A, G, A, G, E, E, A. A triplet of eighth notes is marked with a '3' over the notes in measure 14.

{A}

Musical notation for section {A} (measures 17-24). The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on four staves. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, A, G, G, A, D, E, E, A. Triplet markings (3) are present over the first two measures.

{B} (low, play in 3rd position)

Musical notation for section {B} (measures 25-28). The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on one staff. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, G, A, G, A, G, E.



Notes: So this is clearly the same base tune as Salt Creek, but it has drifted in different directions, depending on who is playing it. This version is based on Terry and Dale Morris's.

Saratoga Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

First system of musical notation (measures 1-8) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: F, B $\flat$, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F.

{B}

Second system of musical notation (measures 9-16) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, C.

{A}

Third system of musical notation (measures 17-24) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: F, B $\flat$, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F.

The musical score is written for guitar in B-flat major (one flat). It consists of five staves of music. The first staff contains the following chords: F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F. The subsequent four staves are primarily composed of Dm and A7 chords, with some triplets indicated by a '3' and a slur. The final staff concludes with a C chord. The notation includes eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together, and rests.

Source: Assembled from versions by Chris Daring, Terry Morris, Christine King, and Tom Weisgerber.

Shetland Set

da Ferry Reel, Lay Dee at Dee, and Miss Spencie's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

♩ = 105

Ferry Reel

Chord progression for Ferry Reel: D, D, Bm, G, Em, A, D, Bm, G, A, A, B $\flat$ 0, Bm, G, A, D.

Lay Dee at Dee

Chord progression for Lay Dee at Dee: D, D, D, A, D, D, A, A, Bm, G, A, D.

Miss Spencie's Reel

Chord progression for Miss Spencie's Reel: D, C, G, D, D, A, D, A, D.

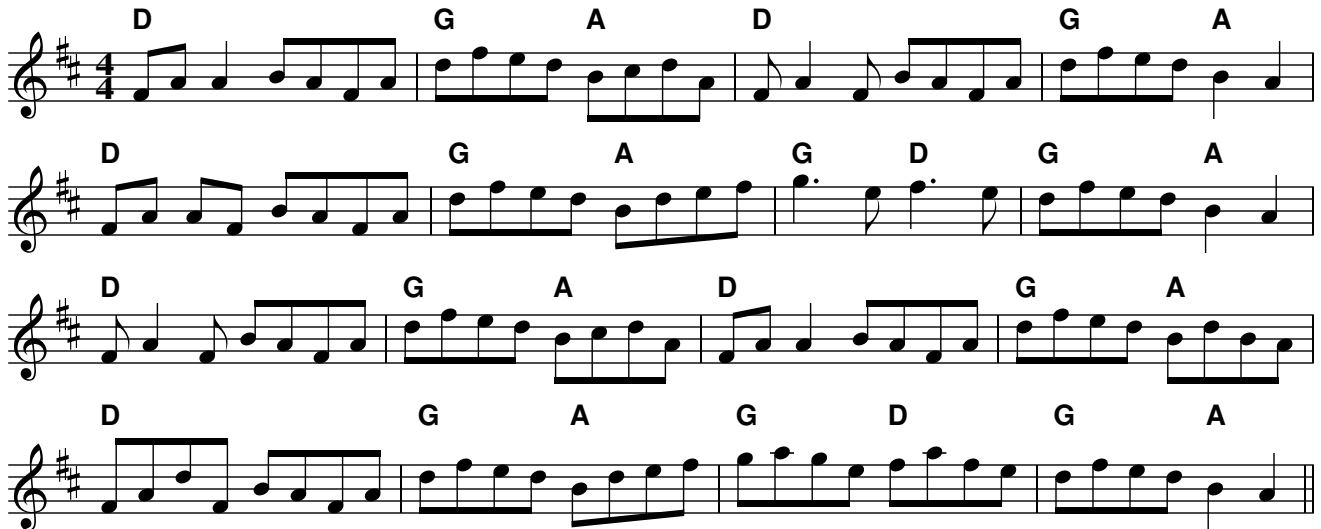
Source: See, e.g. Aly Bain and Tom Anderson, *The Silver Bow: The Fiddle Music of Shetland* (2016).

Notes: This is a common set.

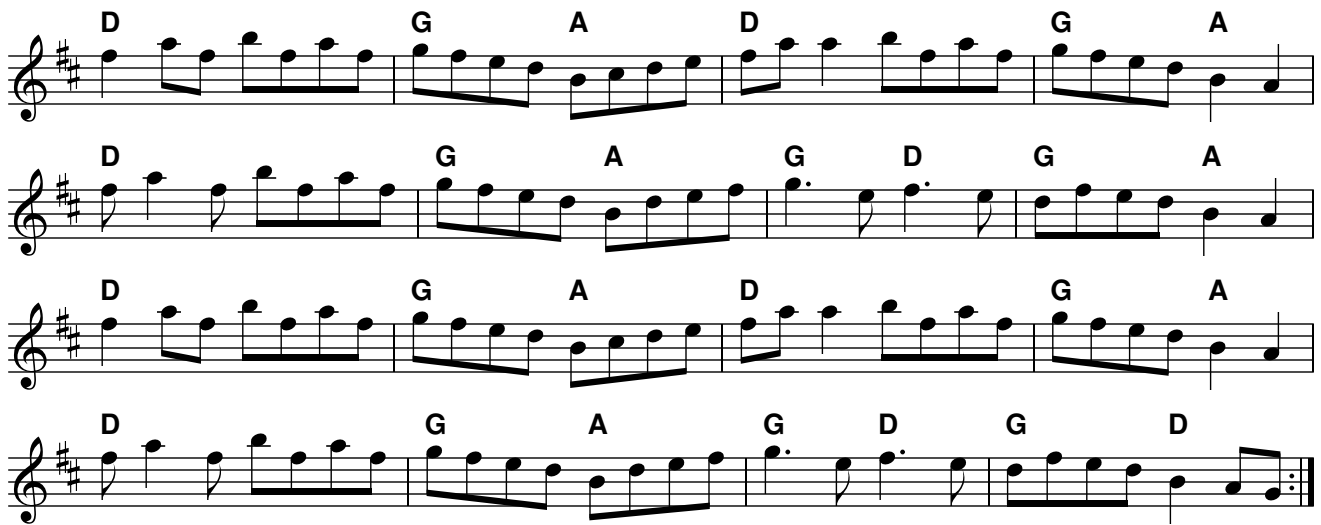
The Silver Spear

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}



{B}



Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/182>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! Popularly paired with Maid Behind the Bar.

Sleep Soond i da Moarnin'

Sleep Sound in the Morning

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Am G Em Am G Am
Am G Em Am G Am
{B}
Am G Am G Am
Am G Am G Am
{B} (var.)
Am G Am G Am
Am G Am G Am

Source: Maggie Sansone, *_Mist and Stone_* (1990).

Notes: Note on the B-part variant: I don't know why, but I always want to play the last C of the rising run as a C#. I know it's out of the key, but I think it sounds awesome.

Smith's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

{B}

Bm G D Bm E7 A7

D Bm G D Bm A7 D

Bm G D Bm E7 A7

D Bm G D Bm A7 D

{A} (var.)

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G $\overset{3}{D}$ Bm $\overset{3}{A7}$ D

Source: Cameron Cross and Joey McKensie

Notes: I've seen some versions where the first chord in the A-part is Bm. I want to like it, but it sounds a little off.

The Spinning Dogs of Carrowkennedy

Damian Caisley
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Chords: Bm, Em, A, Bm, Em, A, F#m, Em, D, A, A7, D, A, Bm, A, Bm, Em, A, Bm, Em, A, F#m, A.

Tempo: $\text{♩} = 105$

Form: {A}, {B}, {A with bridge}, {B}

Notes: Inspired by the sight of two "absolutely mental" dogs spinning around each other in Carrowkennedy. It has a fun "bridge" part you can surprise your friends with. Recommended order is to play through the regular tune {A-B} twice, then on the third time through include the bridge and finish on {B}.

The Stage Hornpipe

James Hill
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chord symbols: {A}, G, G, Am, D7, G, C, D7, D7, G, G, Am, G, G, Am, D7, G.

Source: Adapted from <https://thesession.org/tunes/1249>

Notes: Tricky! I think the best way to play the {B} part is to shift to second position.

The Twenty-Eighth of January

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

{B}

Am Am G G Em

Am Am G Em Am

{A} (var.)

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

{B} (var.)

Am Am G G

Am Am G Em Am

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and thesession.org/tunes/15717 for the base

Notes: Now this is an interesting number! The A-part uses the "Dorian vamp," pretty unusual in fiddle tunes but a staple in classic rock. Seems like a popular bluegrass tune.

Westmoreland's Hornpipe

Terry Morris
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D 4 0 Em D 4 0 A V V

D 4 0 Em A 4 1 A D 2 A D

{B}

D G D A

D 4 0 Em A 4 1 D 2 D

{A}

D Em D A

D 4 0 Em A 4 A D

Source: Terry Morris, *_Touch of Texas_* (1976)

Notes: Very pretty tune. I've marked alternating closed and open strings to give it more tonal variety.

Whiskey Before Breakfast

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

First system of music (A section). Chords: D, G, D, Em, A, D, G, D, A7, D.

{B}

Second system of music (B section). Chords: D, Em, A7, D, A, G, D, G, D, A, D.

{A}

Third system of music (A section). Chords: D, G, D, Em, A, D, G, A7, D.

{B}

Fourth system of music (B section). Chords: D, Em, A7, D, A, G, D, G, D, A, D.

Source: Cameron Cross

Notes: Classic, beautiful tune. Rough transcription of how I like to play it.

---JIGS AND SLIPJIGS---

The Ballykeal Jig

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

F F G G

F F D 1 G 2 G

G D G D

G D D 1 G 2 G

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Chords very tentative (again).

Brose and Butter + Cuzle Together

BB a.k.a. The Peacock Followed The Hen

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

Am G Am G C G C D G

Bonnie's variation

A G A G A G D G

Cuzle Together

A G A D G A D G

Edor version by Fraser and Haas

Em D Em D G A G D Em D Em D

Source: Bonnie Rideout, *_Scottish Fire_* (2000); A. Fraser and N. Haas, *_Fire & Grace_* (2004).

Notes: Bonnie plays this on the viola and it sounds awesome. I've transposed it up a fifth to work on the fiddle. Another interesting thing is that she switches between A dorian (with a C natural) - which seems to be the standard - and mixolydian (C sharp). She combines B&B with Cuzle Together, another slipjig also in Amix (as well as Elsie Marley). This is supplemented with a version in Edor by Fraser and Haas, with a nice B-part.

The Butterfly

Tommy Potts
slipjig

$\text{♩} = 100$
{A}

Em D Em Bm Em D C D



{B}

C Bm Am7 D



{C}

G G D G C D



A-part: Em/D Em/Bm Em/D C/D :|

B-part: C .. Bm .. Am · D · :|

C-part: G .. G/D · G .. C/D :| (The Gs can be substituted for Em's if preferred)

Source: The Good Tune

Notes: I've modified the bowing to something that makes more sense to me. But of course this is just a model to be played with.

Elsie Marley

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score for "Elsie Marley" is written in G major (one sharp) and 9/8 time. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The score consists of six staves of music. The key signature is G major. The time signature is 9/8. The music is a single melodic line with various ornaments (v) and slurs. Chord symbols (A, D, G, Em) are placed above the staff to indicate the harmonic structure. The piece ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Source: Horseplay (Roughshod, 2006), with a few tweaks

Notes: A great romp of a tune. I find it helpful to "pop" the up-bows where marked.

The Maid At The Spinning Wheel

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in G major (one sharp) and 6/8 time. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The score consists of six staves of music. Chords G, D, and A are indicated above the notes. The piece includes repeat signs and first/second endings.

Staff 1: G G G D

Staff 2: G G D 1 G 2 G

Staff 3: G D D D

Staff 4: G D D 1 G 2 G

Staff 5: G D G D A D

Staff 6: G D G D A 1 G 2 G

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

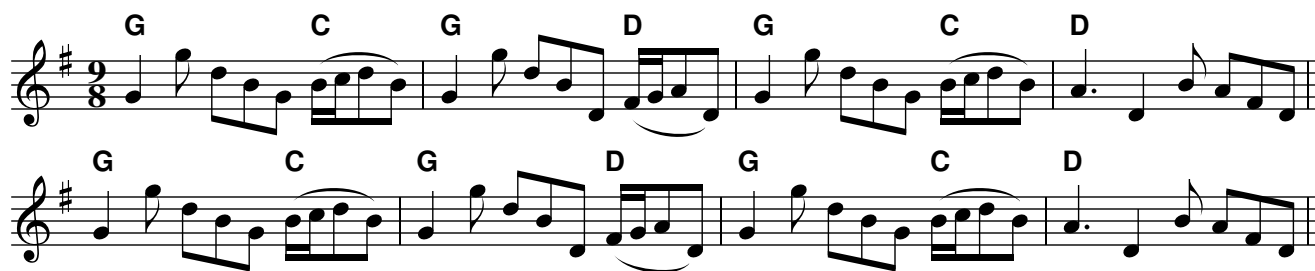
The Yorkshire Trip

a.k.a. Danish Slipjig

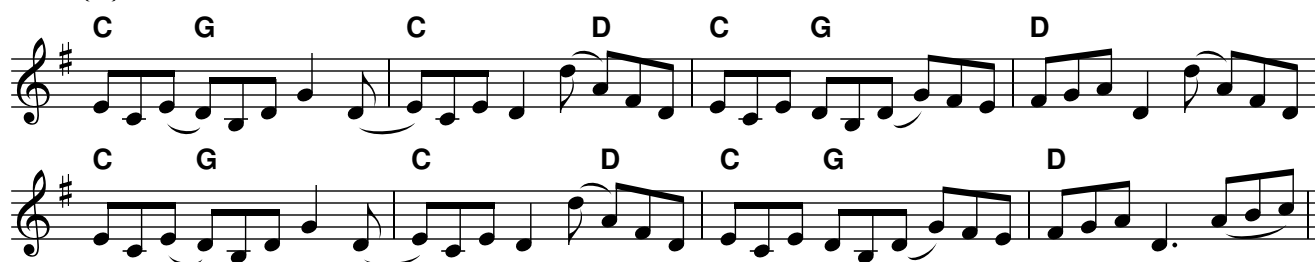
*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A}



{B}



{C}



A-part: G/G/C G/G/D G/G/C D :|

B-part: C/G/G C/D/D C/G/G D :|

C-part: Em .. D ... C ... D :|

Source: William Vickers' Collection of Dance Tunes (1770); The Good Tune
Notes: A very nice slipjig; the sixteenth notes in the first part give it a distinctive touch.

---TUNES OF CHOICE---

The Blackbird (Set Dance)

*Trad.
set dance*

$\text{♩} = 80$

{A}

Part {A} chords: G, Am, D, G, D, D, A, D, G, Am, D, G, D, G 3, D.

Part {B} chords: D, A, D, G, G, D, D, A, D, G, D, D, G, C, C, G, D, C, G, D.

Source: Bobby Gardiner (Memories of Claire, 1996), with my own variations.
Notes: Lovely tune! Unusually (as far as I know), each part ends with an extra two beats.
Has a strong melodic sympathy with the Blackbird Hornpipe. D mixolydian, chords tentative.

Codladh na madraí fada

(Sleep of the Long Dogs)

James Jackson, 2026
air

♩ = 115

Em D G D C G Am Bm

Em D G D C G Bm Em

Em D C D G D Am D

Em D C D C G Bm Em

A-part: Em D G D | C G Am Bm || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

B-part: Em D C D | G D Am D || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

Source: James Jackson

Notes: Written as a lament over the site of a mass grave of greyhounds; see
<http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/england/wear/6457185.stm>. Play slowly with feeling and ornamentation.

Jezebel Carol

*Trad.
carol*

♩ = 160

System 1 (B minor):

- Staff 1: B min, Bm, A
- Staff 2: Bm, D, A
- Staff 3: Bm, A
- Staff 4: Bm, F#m, A, Bm

System 2 (A minor):

- Staff 1: A min, Am, G
- Staff 2: Am, C, G
- Staff 3: Am, G
- Staff 4: Am, Em, Am

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990); Áine Minogue (Between the Worlds, 1997).

Notes: This interesting tune has an extra beat at the end. I've also found it played in both A and B minor. Chords remain tentative.

The Old Crossroads

a.k.a. Down The Brae

*Trad.
march*

♩ = 130

Em Em G Em D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Em Em G D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990)

The Princess Royal

Turlough O'Carolan
set dance

$\text{♩} = 160$

{A} Bm E Bm F#m

A Bm F#m Bm A 1 Bm 2 Bm

{B} Bm E Bm F#m

D E A B F# E

Bm Bm A 1 Bm 2 Bm

Source: Eliot Grasso and Dave Cory, North by NorthWest (2020)

Rodney's Glory

a.k.a. Five in a Line

*Trad.
set dance*

$\text{♩} = 130$

Am G Am D G

Am G Am A

3 3 3

Source: Eliot Grasso & Dave Cory (North by NorthWest, 2020)

---WALTZES---

11.30 in Mallaig

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 150

A D G Em A D Em G

A D Bm A G D A 1 2

Bm D A G D Em G

Bm D A G D A 1 2

Source: Horseplay (Roughshod, 2006)

Notes: BEAUTIFUL melody. I'm still feeling out the chords.

Ameila('s Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 160$

{A}

D D Bm F#m

G D Bm G

D D Bm F#m

G G A

1 3 2

{B}

D D A A

Bm Bm F#m F#m

G D A D

G D A D

Source: Natalie MacMaster (A Compilation, 1996)

Notes: Play it heavily swung.

(The) April (Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 180

Chords: G, D, C, D, Bm, Em, C, G, D7, G, Dsus, Em, C, G, Em, C, D, Em, Em, C, D, Em, C, G, D, C

Captain O'Kane

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 180$

{A}

Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em

{B}

Em Em D Bm Am G Bm Em G Em7 D Bm G Am Em Em

Source: Loosely adapted from Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Can make some great harmonies! I added a high part for reference.

The Ken Meadows Waltz

Martin Matthews
waltz

$\text{♩} = 115$

{A} F#m A II

D 1 A E 2 A E 3 A

{B} E A II

D 1 A E 2 A 3 A

{C} E A II

D A E A 3 A 3

A II D A E 3 A

Tvihuga (Mixed Feelings)

Sturla Eide
waltz

$\text{♩} = 130$

{A}

G D C D

G D C D 1 G 2 G

{B}

C Em D Em

C Em D Em

C D G 1 2

{A}

B $\flat$ F E $\flat$ F

B $\flat$ F E $\flat$ F 1 B $\flat$ 2 B $\flat$

{B}

E $\flat$ Gm F Gm

E $\flat$ Gm F Gm

E $\flat$ F B $\flat$ 1 2

Source: Sturla Eide, Murru (2006). https://youtu.be/CdXmH3nog9w?si=_6Wh9K9-J2iFgw1y

Two Rivers

Larry Unger (1986)
waltz

$\text{♩} = 180$ **Bm** **F#m**

Bm **G** **A**

D **F#m**

Bm **A** | 1 **G** | 2 **G**

Bm **A**

Bm **G** **A** **Bm**

Bm **G** **A** **Bm**

F#m | 1 **G** **A** | 2 **G** **A**

Source: _The Curvy Road to Corinth_ by Larry Unger.

Notes: Written at a campsite on Lake Michigan in Two Rivers, WI.